

****The CNIL publishes its annual report 2023****

April 23, 2024

Information and protection of individuals, support and advice, anticipation and innovation, controls and sanctions: the CNIL presents its 2023 assessment, the year marking the 5th anniversary of the implementation of the GDPR, characterized by a record number of complaints received and a rethought support policy.

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The publication of its activity report allows the CNIL to account for its actions concerning its four main missions: to inform and protect the general public, to support and advise professionals and public authorities, to anticipate and innovate to build the digital landscape of tomorrow, and finally to control and sanction breaches of the General Data Protection Regulation and the law.

****Download the CNIL's 2023 activity report****

****Download the CNIL in brief – 2024 edition****

****Inform and Protect****

In spring 2023, the CNIL decided to create a public awareness mission, in addition to its ongoing actions. In this context, the CNIL met with more than 2,500 people during conferences or workshops in 6 regions. In terms of digital education, the CNIL also continued its actions, offering 81 interventions in 9 regions and meeting 4,300 people, including 1,500 young individuals.

The year 2023 was particularly marked by a significant increase in requests from the general public. The CNIL processed 16,433 complaints (+35% compared to 2022) and, for the second consecutive year, it handled as many as it received. It also received 20,810 requests for the exercise of indirect rights (for access to certain banking or police files) through the opening of a dedicated online service, representing a 217% increase in one year.

The website cnil.fr recorded another record audience this year, with 11.8 million visits, reflecting an ever-growing interest from both professionals and individuals in data protection, particularly regarding phishing, cookies, or artificial intelligence. Furthermore, the CNIL noted a 35% increase in visits to its "Need Help" Q&A; database, especially on topics related to the national file of payment incidents (FICP) or criminal records.

- ****47,111**** calls answered during telephone support sessions
- ****11.8 million**** visits to CNIL websites
- ****16,433**** complaints received
- ****20,810**** admissible requests for the exercise of indirect rights received

****Support and Advise****

Supporting professionals in their compliance efforts is one of the CNIL's essential missions.

In 2023, it enriched its support strategy by focusing on artificial intelligence: on one hand, through enhanced support for companies with significant economic or innovation potential; on the other hand, through the third edition of its "sandbox," dedicated this year to public service projects.

Beyond sector-specific and, in some cases, individual support (1,651 advice requests received in 2023), the CNIL produced 13 new reference documents: 5 new guides, 4 reference frameworks, 2 recommendations, and 2 reference methodologies for the health sector.

Finally, it continued its regional visits as part of the "GDPR Days," meeting with professionals and students in Reims, Rennes, Marseille, and Toulouse.

- ****13**** new reference documents including 5 guides, 4 reference frameworks, 2 recommendations, and 2 reference methodologies in health.
- ****3**** innovative companies benefit from enhanced support
- ****4**** AI projects supported within the "personal data" sandbox

****Anticipate and Innovate****

Continuing from previous years, the CNIL has maintained close ties with the research community, notably by organizing the second edition of the Privacy Research Day, an international conference facilitating dialogue between regulators and researchers.

Additionally, as part of its anticipation and support missions, the CNIL published a roadmap on artificial intelligence, following 3 fundamental principles: guiding the development of privacy-respecting AI, uniting and supporting innovative actors, and auditing existing systems to protect individuals. Finally, in the current environmental context, it has become necessary to explore the intersections between data protection and environmental issues: this articulation is the subject of the ninth IP notebook from the CNIL's Digital Innovation Laboratory (LINC), "Data, Footprint, and Freedoms." The CNIL also organized its ethical event air2023, gathering 1,700 participants both on-site and remotely. It published a report in 2024, summarizing the main themes and debates of the event in the form of testimonies and interviews.

- **32** articles and reports published on linc.cnil.fr
- **4,439** participants during the Privacy Research Day

Control and Sanction

The CNIL continued a sustained enforcement activity: it conducted 340 inspections, predominantly... on-site and online, whether based on complaints or on its own initiative (priority themes, information published in the press, etc.).

42 sanctions were imposed (which is twice as many as in 2022), including 36 fines totaling 89,179,500 euros. In addition, the president of the CNIL issued 168 formal notices, as well as 33 reminders of legal obligations, against organizations that committed violations of data protection regulations.

This is also the year in which the simplified procedure gained real momentum.

Created in 2021 to adapt procedures to cases that do not present any particular legal difficulty, it allows the CNIL to act even more effectively in response to the ever-increasing number of complaints. Thus, 24 sanctions – more than half of the total – were imposed within this framework.

340
inspections

42
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36
fines totaling nearly 90 million euros

Reference text

For further reading

The CNIL publishes its strategic plan 2022-2024

The CNIL's inspections in 2024: data of minors, Olympic Games, right of access, and dematerialized receipts

The missions of the CNIL

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